

TEAM 1711, RAPTORS PLAN FOR

BUILDING

 **OUTSTANDING**

NETWORKS FOR

ENGINEERING

SUCCESS

OUR TEAM



For team 1711, robotics is more than just robots; it's about helping people see that they belong in STEM. For the past 20 years, our team has been making STEM more accessible and meaningful in our community. What started in 2006 with a math teacher and a small group of students forming the first FRC team in Northern Michigan has grown into something much bigger than just our team.

Through over a decade of outreach and dozens of events in just the past few years, we've focused on more than just introducing students to FIRST. We help them build confidence in STEM and start to see a future for themselves in it. Today, we're reaching thousands of people in our community and all across the world.

THE HISTORY OF TEAM 1711

2006

First high school to host a long-running FRC event in **Michigan**, the **nation**, and the **world**. Still hosted today

The founding of Team 1711

2009

The first Super Science Saturday, hosted annually.

2010

Founded FRC Team 3767 The TC Titans

2011

RAPTORS Instagram account created

2015

TikTok account created

JANUARY

2025

Construction of our Innovation and manufacturing center that we work closely with our school to develop.

SPRING 2025

First LEGO Spike Camps

SUMMER 2025

FALL 2025

First Bot Toks episode posted

Helped support FLL team The Robotic Builders through their first season.

JANUARY 2026

Became the most followed FRC team in michigan across Instagram and TikTok.

APRIL 2026

Bring FTC Teams to homeschool communities with teaching sessions for families.

SUMMER 2026

Increases reach of social media and focus on educational content.

OCTOBER 2025

Celebrated 20th year of team with Sponsors and Alumni to increase awareness while celebrating our time in FRC.

MARCH 2026

Collaborated with Turkish team, IMC, to create a series of videos about FIRST for Khan Academy.

SUMMER 2026

6 sessions of LEGO SPIKE camps held.

ONGOING FUTURE

OUR ENGINEERING SUCCESS NETWORKS

SUPER SCIENCE SATURDAY



Super Science Saturday is an engaging event that our team, Team 1711, has proudly hosted for 16 years. This initiative aims to inspire children aged 4 to 14 through more than 12 distinct experiments, each designed to teach scientific principles in an enjoyable and innovative manner. Annually, we inspire over 500 children through our efforts. This year marked a significant milestone, as we hosted the event for the first time in our school's new STEM space, providing young participants with a glimpse into their future within the FIRST community. Additionally, we showcased our robot, further cultivating interest in robotics. The event's enduring success is reflected in the fact that many current team members recall their own experiences attending this event.

LEGO STEM CAMPS



A new initiative that our team has taken this year is LEGO STEM camps. This introduces kids in grades 3-5 to the fundamentals of FIRST. At these camps, we hosted over 60 kids, teaching them the basics of robotics through the same parts used in FLL. This led to more engagement with FLL in our community and even caused the formation of an independent FLL team. This impacted our community by building up the next generation of FIRST participants and creating a love for STEM in our youth community.

OUR ENGINEERING SUCCESS NETWORKS

This year, our team launched an innovative initiative: LEGO STEM camps.

Designed for children in grades 3-5, these camps introduce the fundamentals of FIRST. We welcomed over 60 kids, teaching them the basics of robotics using the same components found in FLL. Our efforts significantly contributed to the formation of the ROBOTIC Builders, an independent FLL team based in Traverse City. Working with the kids was an incredible experience, and our team was able to help them dramatically. As a result, we are nurturing the next generation of FIRST participants and fostering a passion for STEM within our youth community.

FLL TEAM THE ROBOTIC BUILDERS



VOLUNTEERING AT MAKER'S FEST



Each year, our team eagerly participates in the Makers Fest, beautifully organized by our local libraries. This event connects us with the community and allows us to share our enthusiasm for STEM education. We volunteer at the Ozobots table, introducing children to coding basics and the exciting world of STEM. These small yet captivating robots ignite curiosity and excitement in parents and kids alike. By showcasing Ozobots' capabilities, we hope to inspire a lasting interest in the exhilarating world of FIRST, motivating young minds to explore and innovate.

OUR ENGINEERING SUCCESS NETWORKS

CYBERSECURITY PRESENTATION



In recognition of Cybersecurity Month, our team delivered a presentation for the local senior center focused on internet safety. We addressed essential topics, including password security, identifying scammers, and distinguishing between human-generated content and artificial intelligence. As technology and AI continue to evolve rapidly, we aim to ensure that everyone remains safe across all digital platforms. This presentation allows us to aid seniors in preventing real-life danger while helping them discover measures to stay safe as technology grows more complex.

ROBOT VISIT TO CENTRAL GRADE ELEMENTARY

Our team regularly visits local elementary schools, including our much-anticipated annual trip to Central Grade Elementary. During these visits, we not only showcase our robot and demonstrate its innovative features but also actively engage with the students. Our aim is to inspire their interest in FIRST and ignite a passion for STEM fields, encouraging them to explore the exciting possibilities these areas offer.



OUR ENGINEERING SUCCESS NETWORKS

MIDDLE SCHOOL PRESENTATION



Our team frequently visits the local middle school to share valuable insights about our group and conduct a variety of interactive classroom activities. We mainly concentrate on STEM classes, which effectively ignites interest in our team and draws in new members. The engaging nature of these sessions has proven to be quite successful, as this year, around 45% of our freshmen joined us due to these visits. This initiative not only helps students learn more about STEM but also fosters a sense of community and collaboration, encouraging them to become a part of our growing team.

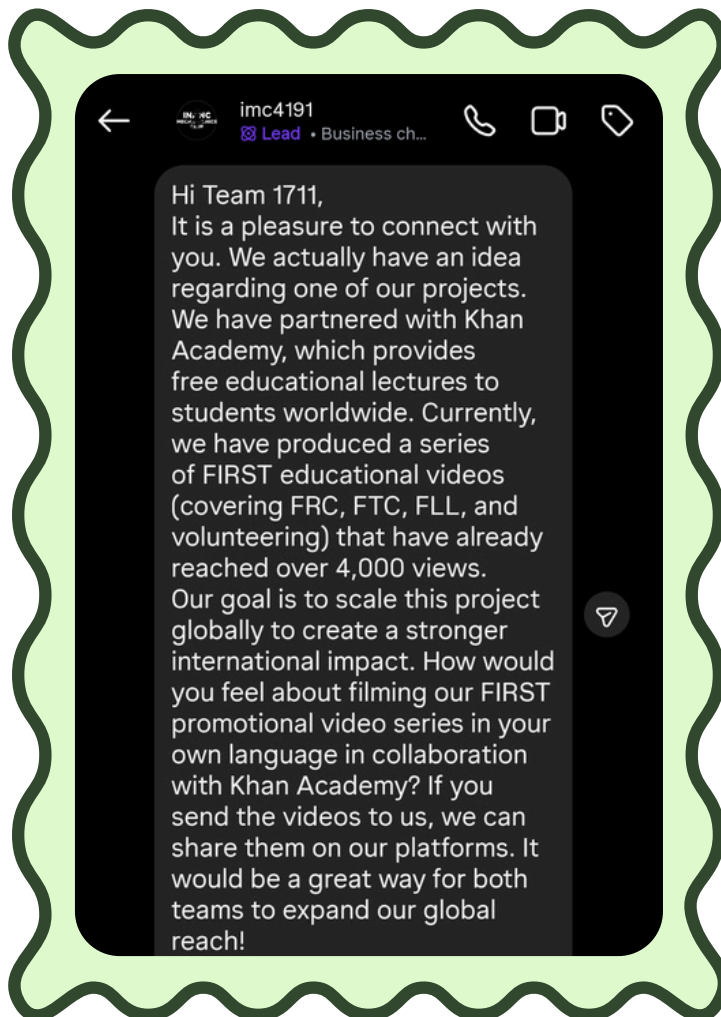
MIDDLE SCHOOL FIELD TRIP TO OUR FRC COMPETITIONS

Each year, we invite middle and elementary school students to participate in our TC competition. This opportunity provides children in our community with a direct experience of an FRC competition, encouraging both kids and their families to engage with our team. Not only does this foster increased community support, but it also raises awareness and interest in FRC and FIRST.

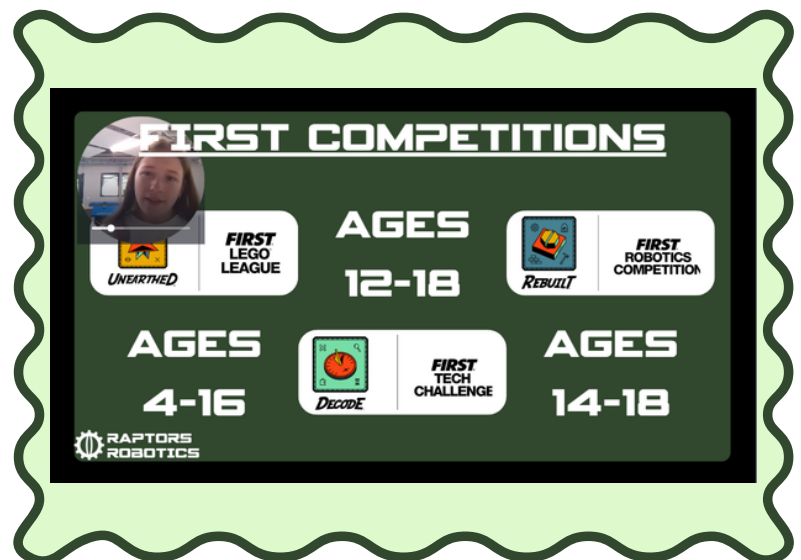
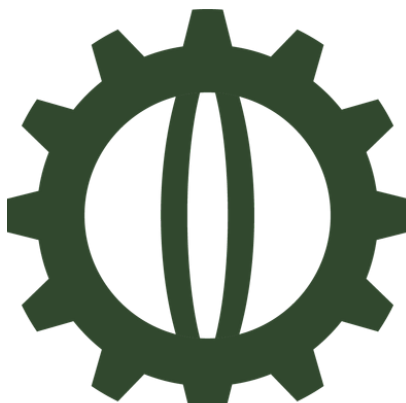


OUR DIGITAL ENGINEERING SUCCESS NETWORK

OUR KHAN CONTRIBUTIONS

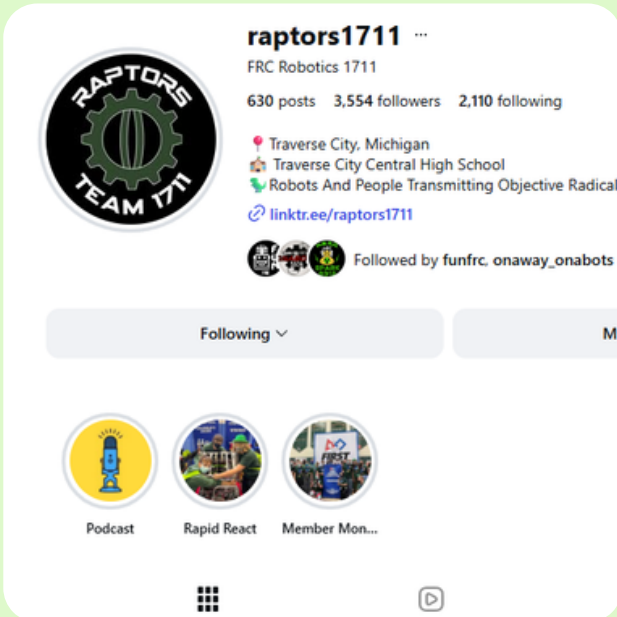


Our team has been working in collaboration with team 4191 IMC from Turkey to create a series of videos in English for their series “Parts to practice” in collaboration with Khan Academy. They chose us to collaborate with in order to expand the reach of their series and better educate the First community.



OUR DIGITAL ENGINEERING SUCCESS NETWORK

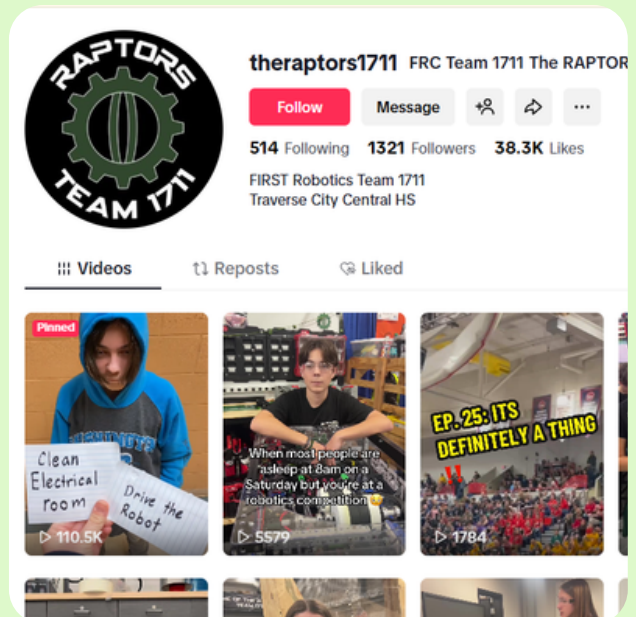
OUR INSTAGRAM OUTREACH



The RAPTORS have been active on Instagram since 2015, but we have been working on deepening our involvement since January of 2025. We regularly create a range of posts, such as sponsor thank you's, member introductions, and updates for our community. Through our engaging video content, we have become influential figures in the robotics community. We have acquired over **3 million collective views**, made over **1.8 million impressions**, and reached over **4400 followers**.

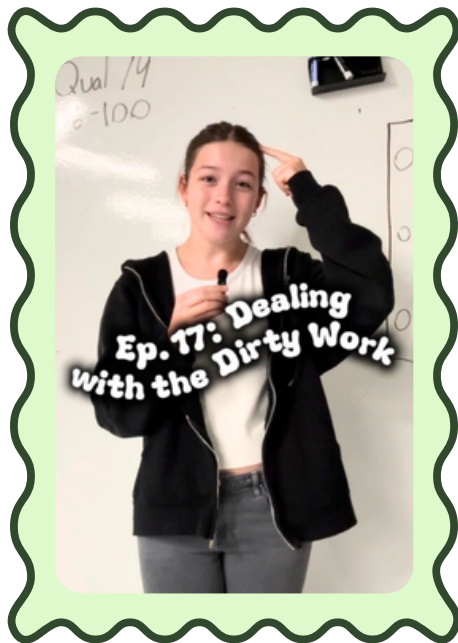
OUR TIKTOK OUTREACH

The RAPTORS have been actively engaging on TikTok since January 2025. We consistently share videos that are both educational and entertaining, providing valuable insights and fun content to our audience. Through this approach, we are not only expanding our reach but also fostering a closer connection with the robotics community. By regularly updating and interacting with our followers, we are building a vibrant and supportive network that encourages learning and innovation in robotics. We've reached **720K collective views**, roughly **51K total likes**, and over **1500 followers**.



OUR DIGITAL ENGINEERING SUCCESS NETWORK

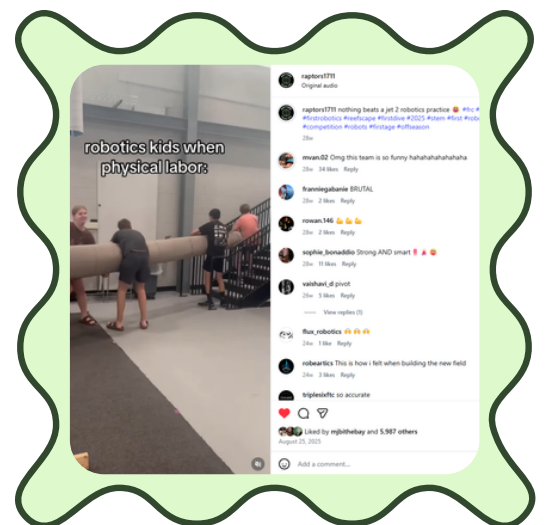
OUR BOT TOKS SERIES



This is one of our best performing videos to date at 208,000 views. Short, fun, and relatable content is the hallmark of the RAPTORS social media present. Our goal is to represent the trials, tribulations, and successes of our team in a fun and engaging way while also getting a few laughs.

This past offseason, we wanted to use the momentum we had built to use our platform for FIRST education. Our Bot Toks Season was born. In this series, we break down tons of skills, experiences, and challenges related to competing in robotics. As of ep.33, we have made over **100,000 impressions** through Bot Toks alone and acquired over **140,000 views!** We love this series because it gives us the opportunities to connect with and educate students across the globe

SHORT FORM CONTENT



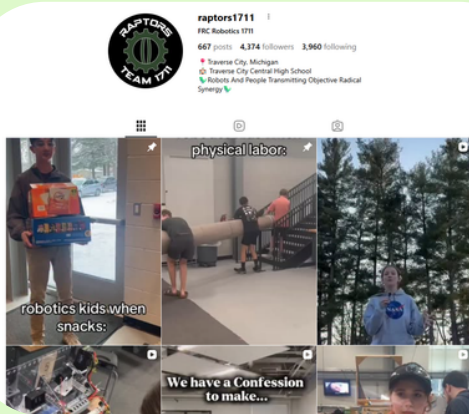
WOMEN'S HISTORY MONTH POSTS

In recognition of all of the female trailblazers in STEM and Women's History Month, we are using our platform to highlight womankind's contributions to STEM. Every day, we feature a woman and her achievements from across all STEM fields. Some of the women we have given a spotlight to are Sally Ride, Ada Lovelace, Rosalind Franklin, and more. It is one of our greatest honors to recognize these heroes who make today's world possible.



OUR PLAN TO EXTEND OUR ENGINEERING SUCCESS NETWORKS

In the coming year, our objective is to introduce the FIRST Tech Challenge (FTC) to homeschooled students, while also providing mentorship opportunities for both the children and their parents. Within our community, there is a significant deficiency in STEM education for homeschooled children, and as RAPTORS, we are committed to addressing this gap.



Throughout the previous season, we observed significant growth in the reach of our social media content. Our goal is to continue expanding this reach in the future. We plan to increase our output of educational content and attract more followers, thereby enhancing our overall engagement and influence.

This year, we successfully hosted two sessions of our LEGO SPIKE CAMPS. For the summer of 2026, we plan to expand our offerings to six sessions, accommodating 30 children each, ultimately reaching a total of 180 participants. Our goal is to inspire these young minds to pursue interests in both STEM and robotics.



SPONSOR DISCOVERY



Our sponsors are an integral part of team 1711, as they support all of our excavations. One of the ways we connect with sponsors is touring their place of business. Our team members have visited Britten Inc, Cone Drive, RJG, Great Lakes Stainless, Strata, and more. These visits allow us to see the engineering that powers our community and deepens our relationship with our sponsors.

To discover sponsors, we engage in "sponsor runs" in our local community. Once a month during the offseason, we contact and visit with local businesses. Sometimes we have specific businesses in mind, but sometimes we choose an area and visit everyone. This practice allows us to introduce ourselves to local businesses in a low-commitment way so we can tell them about our team confidently and genuinely.



SPONSOR RETENTION



We want to ensure that our sponsors are involved in our team. To accomplish this, we host our sponsors in our practice space for numerous events. We hosted our sponsors in the opening of our new space this year, allowing them to see our growth as a team. We also host tours and presentations, giving us a chance to update sponsors on our season progress.

This year, we had an amazing opportunity to celebrate our sponsors at our 20th anniversary party. We want to recognize all of the sponsors that have contributed to our success since 2006, so we threw a party in our new practice space to celebrate how far we have come. This gave our team the opportunity to connect with sponsors and learn about their businesses, allowing us all to become more intertwined.



OUR INTRA- TEAM SUCCESS NETWORKS

SUBJECT MATTER EXPERT

Our team is immensely proud of our Subject Matter Expert (SME) leadership system, which significantly enhances the diversity of our team's skills and fosters an inclusive environment for all interested in STEM. This framework allows multiple individuals to become SMEs within a single subteam, with their designation based purely on merit and skills demonstrated over time. Consequently, we are thrilled to report that 42% of our leadership is female, and 40% of leadership roles are held by individuals from cultural minorities or the LGBTQ+ community. Had we adopted a leadership model based on popularity or appointments by mentors, we might not have achieved these remarkable results due to the persistent cultural barriers within the STEM community.

Our team has introduced the "SME Constitution," a document that outlines the formal process for becoming a Subject Matter Expert (SME) for a designated subteam. This constitution provides clear guidelines and details the responsibilities associated with the role. We believe the system is well-structured and straightforward. To qualify as an SME, one must deliver a presentation to the entire team about their specific subteam, possess a Varsity Letter, and obtain approval from a mentor with at least three-quarters support.



OUR SME'S



AVIANNAH STIEVE
COMMUNICATIONS SME



CHARLIE HAMMERSLEY
PROGRAMING/SAFETY SME



FRANNIE HARBOLD
ELECTRICAL SME



KAYDEN MCMILLAN
DESIGN/BUILD/ STRATEGY
SME



MADISON VANDENBERG
ELECTRICAL SME



MILO WOODRUFF
STRATEGY SME



OSCAR FALCON
PROGRAMING/ STRATEGY
SME